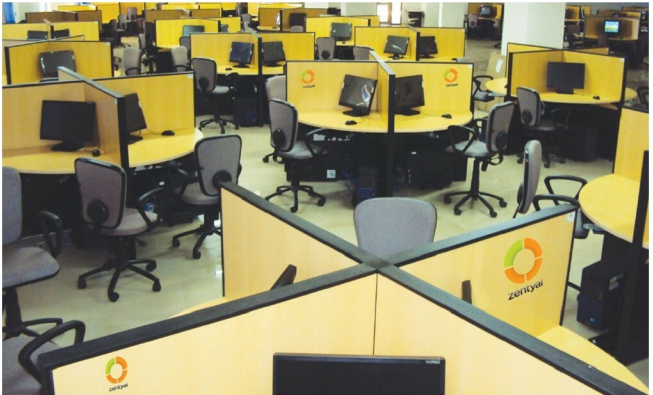


Manage Your IT Infrastructure Effectively with Zentyal



Read about how Inmantec Institutions switched to Zentyal (formerly e-box Platform), which is a program for a Linux server and is meant for SMBs. Zentyal has a multi-faceted platform, as we will discover through this series.

Over the past many years, Inmantec Institutions had faced issues in managing its IT infrastructure.

Problems included handling static IP pools for students and staff, managing Internet bandwidth such that it was not misused, etc. Here's a first hand account of how open source helped the institute manage its IT infrastructure efficiently and in a cost-effective manner.

For years, Inmantec used commercial software to manage its IT infrastructure. And like all proprietary software, this, too, did not provide the institution with a customised solution to manage the IP addresses of its students and staff, efficiently. In the case of static IP addresses, the institution was provided with four VLANs for all the staff and students of different courses. Most of the time, the organisation used IP addresses. These large static IP address pools had performance issues on commercial software. Inmantec required features like a captive portal, a DHCP server, real-time monitoring of users' downloads and uploads with

statistics, etc. With all these issues to be addressed, different open source software were tested till Zentyal server was discovered. It resolved most of the problems.

Zentyal is a Linux-based business server, which is a replacement for Microsoft Small Business Server and Microsoft Exchange Server. The beauty of the software lies in its simplicity, short installation period and minimal maintenance. The features that attracted Inmantec to Zentyal were:

1. Communication Server, which has a mail server, groupware and instant messaging system.
2. Office Server, which contains an LDAP directory server, file sharing and domain services, printer sharing and backup facilities.
3. Systems Management, which is a software management utility and monitors hardware performance.
4. The infrastructure, which comprises a DHCP server, a DNS server, an NTP server, a certification authority, Apache Webserver, an FTP server and UPS management.